

UAT Governance & Business Acceptance Model

A controlled business-validation model that separates functional QA from operational acceptance.

PORTFOLIO ARTIFACT QS-03	SCOPE Enterprise Salesforce Delivery	EDITION Sanitized / Generalized
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GOVERNANCE PRINCIPLE
QA validates functionality, regression risk, evidence, and residual risk. The authorized business/UAT owner validates real operational usefulness and owns the acceptance decision.

Why This Model Exists

- Prevent UAT from becoming the first serious functional test.
- Ensure the business tester receives a stable build, clear scope, representative data, known issues, and QA context.
- Make acceptance authority explicit so approval is traceable rather than assumed.
- Separate product defects from training, policy, preference, data, and operational-readiness feedback.
- Preserve a clear decision record for release planning and accepted risk.

Entry Criteria: Ready for UAT

ENTRY CONDITION	MINIMUM EVIDENCE
QA outcome permits UAT	QA completion summary is recorded with coverage, defects, limitations, and residual risk.
Business owner identified	The UAT tester or business owner has explicit decision authority or a defined escalation path.
Environment and access ready	UAT environment, permissions, integrations, and required services are available.
Representative data ready	Test data supports realistic business scenarios without exposing sensitive production information.
Scenarios prepared	Business workflows reflect operational use—not only technical acceptance criteria.
Known issues disclosed	Open defects, limitations, workarounds, and accepted risks are visible before execution.
Schedule and support set	Execution window, support contacts, defect path, and retest expectations are known.

QA-to-UAT Handoff

STEP	REQUIRED ACTION	ACCOUNTABLE ROLE
1	QA posts the completion summary: outcome, build/environment, coverage, defects, limitations, and residual risk.	QA
2	Confirm the UAT owner has access, data, scenarios, schedule, and decision authority.	Product / BA + QA
3	Move the ticket from QA Complete to Ready for UAT.	QA or agreed workflow owner
4	Change assignment to the person performing or coordinating UAT.	QA or Product / BA
5	UAT owner acknowledges the handoff and moves the item to In UAT when execution begins.	UAT Tester / Business Owner

HANDOFF STANDARD

The UAT tester should not need to reconstruct context from chat. The ticket should contain the tested build, business scope, scenarios, known issues, relevant evidence, access/data notes, and support path.

Roles and Decision Boundaries

ROLE	OWNS	DOES NOT OWN
UAT Tester / Business Owner	Executes realistic end-to-end business workflows and issues the authorized acceptance decision.	Independent functional QA or technical implementation.
Quality Assurance	Supports data/access/evidence, reproduces issues, classifies defects, and coordinates retesting.	Business acceptance or risk authorization.
Product Owner / Business Analyst	Clarifies intended behavior, scope, business rules, and disposition of feedback.	Independent QA outcome.
Developer / Technical Lead	Corrects confirmed defects and supports technical diagnosis.	Business acceptance.
Release Lead	Uses the UAT decision and conditions as release-readiness inputs.	Replacing UAT decision authority.

Execution Model

CONTROL	PRACTICE
Business workflow execution	Use representative roles and data to validate realistic operational journeys from the user/business perspective.
Evidence capture	Record scenario result, data/role used, screenshots or other evidence when useful, and any operational observation.
Issue classification	Classify findings as defect, requirement gap, training issue, policy/process issue, preference/enhancement, data issue, or environment issue.
Defect handling	For confirmed defects, document business impact and expected behavior, route correction to development, then perform targeted QA retest before business re-validation.
Risk handling	Any decision to proceed with unresolved risk requires a named authorized owner, rationale, impact, workaround, and follow-up date.
Status integrity	Use Ready for UAT → In UAT → UAT Accepted, UAT Failed, Reopened, Deferred, or equivalent visible statuses.

Decision Outcomes

OUTCOME	MEANING	NEXT ACTION
ACCEPTED	Required business scenarios support operational use; no unresolved condition blocks acceptance.	Proceed to release planning / release candidate.
CONDITIONALLY ACCEPTED	Business accepts with documented conditions, owned actions, or authorized residual risk.	Proceed only if release governance accepts the conditions.
REJECTED	Business workflow does not satisfy required operational behavior.	Return to the responsible stage for correction and re-validation.
DEFERRED	Acceptance cannot be completed due to timing, dependency, access, data, policy, or unresolved decision.	Keep work visible; assign owner and next review date.

Exit Criteria and Evidence

EXIT CONDITION	EVIDENCE
Required business scenarios complete	The agreed operational workflows have been executed or explicitly dispositioned.
Authorized decision recorded	Acceptance, conditional acceptance, rejection, or deferral is issued by the accountable business owner.
Issues dispositioned	Defects and conditions are corrected, formally accepted, deferred, or converted to owned follow-up work.
Operational actions visible	Training, communications, support, policy/process updates, or other readiness actions have owners.
Release scope traceable	The accepted ticket/scope is linked to the intended release or release candidate.
Evidence preserved	Scenario results, signoff, accepted risk, conditions, and follow-up actions are retained in the work record.

Anti-Patterns to Prevent

ANTI-PATTERN	BETTER PRACTICE
UAT is the first functional test	Complete structured QA first and disclose residual risk before business validation.
Tester is assigned without context	Use a formal QA-to-UAT handoff with scope, build, data, access, scenarios, known issues, and evidence.
QA gives business acceptance	QA reports test outcome and risk; the business owner makes the operational acceptance decision.
Every UAT comment becomes a defect	Classify defect vs requirement gap, training, process/policy, preference, data, or environment issue.
Approval is verbal or implied	Record the authorized decision, conditions, accepted risk, and owner in the system of record.

PORTFOLIO SANITIZATION NOTE

This portfolio edition is a generalized adaptation of an enterprise quality operating model. Institutional names, logos, internal ticket identifiers, personnel, URLs, environment names, proprietary fields, and implementation-specific details have been removed or generalized. The artifact is presented to demonstrate quality engineering method, governance, and leadership practice.